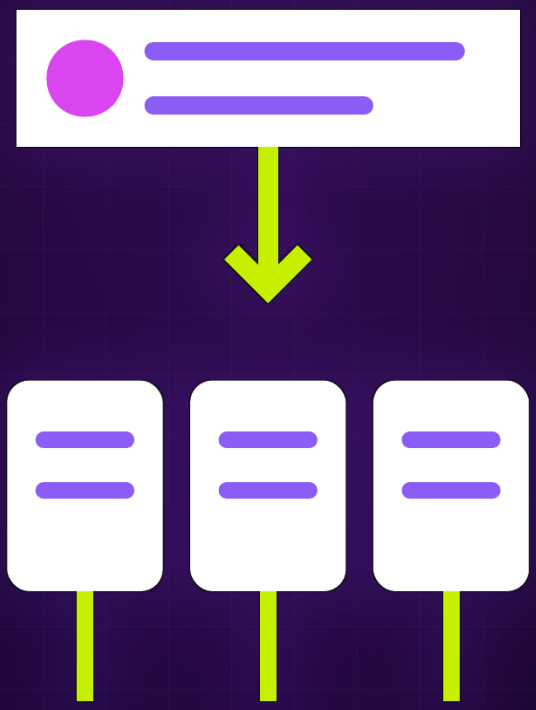
MATCHBOIL FILE ARTIFACT HUNT

Hunts source-observed MATCHBOIL payload and configuration artifacts.

HUNTING QUERY

CONFIDENCE: MEDIUM



REPORT DATE
13 October 2026

STATUS
Untested implementation sketch

PRIMARY PLATFORM
Microsoft Defender XDR

OPERATIONAL VALUE
7.0 / 10

EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT

Decision, confidence and evidence boundary.

ASSESSMENT

OPERATIONAL VALUE

7.0

Hunts source-observed MATCHBOIL payload and configuration artifacts.

CLASSIFICATION

Hunting query

Medium confidence. Source-supported campaign evidence; environmental prevalence is not validated.

1 primary table
1 primary query
0 production claims
4 validation gates

Evidence boundary

An artifact match does not prove execution, persistence, C2, compromise, or UAC-0099 attribution.

BEHAVIOR AND EVIDENCE

Observed facts separated from analytical scope.

MECHANICS

#	Source-supported fact
1	ESET described MATCHBOIL as a C# downloader used by UAC-0099.
2	Observed artifacts included WallpappersSet.jpg, config.library-ms, and SMTPClientApplication.exe.
3	Variants used Run keys or scheduled tasks, but consistent endpoint write telemetry was not published.

Detection hypothesis

If the published behavior occurs in a covered endpoint or cloud workload, DeviceFileEvents should retain the campaign-specific evidence used by this hunt.

Unconfirmed elements

An artifact match does not prove execution, persistence, C2, compromise, or UAC-0099 attribution.

ATT&CK: T1036.005

TELEMETRY CONTRACT

Collection prerequisites and field reliability.

TELEMETRY

REQUIRED

DeviceFileEvents

Microsoft Defender XDR advanced hunting coverage must retain the fields referenced by the query.

OPTIONAL ENRICHMENT

Identity, device, network, file reputation, prevalence, owner, change record, and adjacent-event context.

Requirement	Decision
Primary platform	Microsoft Defender XDR
Primary table	DeviceFileEvents
Query status	Untested implementation sketch
Classification	Hunting; no alerting before validation

Coverage caveat

An empty result may mean no match, missing telemetry, retention gaps, parser differences, or field sparsity.

PRIMARY KQL

Source-supported conditions with investigable output.

HUNTING

STATUS

Hunting query — Untested implementation sketch

KQL — UNTESTED

```
// MATCHBOIL payload and configuration artifact hunt
// Platform: Microsoft Defender XDR Advanced Hunting
// Status: Hunting query - Untested implementation sketch
// Confidence: Medium
// Telemetry prerequisite: Microsoft Defender for Endpoint populating DeviceFileEvents
// Scope: Use the portal time selector appropriate to local retention and the investigation.
// Interpretation: A row is an artifact match. It does not prove execution, persistence,
// C2 communication, compromise, or UAC-0099 attribution.
DeviceFileEvents
| where
    (FileName == "SMTPClientApplication.exe"
        and FolderPath endswith @"\AppData\Local\SMTPClient")
    or (FileName == "config.library-ms"
        and FolderPath == @"C:\Users\Public\Libraries")
    or (FileName == "WallpappersSet.jpg"
        and FolderPath endswith @"\Pictures")
| project Timestamp, DeviceId, DeviceName, ActionType, FileName, FolderPath,
          SHA1, InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine,
          InitiatingProcessAccountName
| order by Timestamp desc
```

TRIAGE AND TUNING

Human validation before response.

WORKFLOW

1
Preserve

Retain the raw event, device or account, timestamps, and campaign-matched values.

2
Confirm

Validate field semantics and determine whether the matched object exists.

3
Enrich

Add reputation, prevalence, owner, identity, network, and adjacent-event context.

4
Scope

Search for related execution, persistence, access, and follow-on activity.

Expected benign overlap

Administration, software development, security testing, automation, content inspection, shared infrastructure, or legitimate files may overlap. Tune only after ownership and prevalence are established.

Response boundary

An artifact match does not prove execution, persistence, C2, compromise, or UAC-0099 attribution.

VALIDATION GATES

Controlled tests and promotion criteria.

QUALITY CONTROL

Validation steps

1. Confirm the primary table and every projected field exist.
2. Replay an authorized benign event matching the query shape.
3. Measure at least 30 days of tenant prevalence and benign overlap.
4. Verify every result retains sufficient evidence for triage.

Decision criteria

Success: the test is visible and real matches remain attributable.

Rejection: benign activity dominates or the campaign artifact is no longer reliable.

Failure: required telemetry or fields are unavailable.

Promotion gate

Do not promote to production until telemetry, prevalence, ownership, and false-positive handling are demonstrated in the target environment.

CONCLUSION AND REFERENCES

Coverage statement and document control.

FINAL

CONCLUSION

Hunting query

Hunts source-observed MATCHBOIL payload and configuration artifacts.

An artifact match does not prove execution, persistence, C2, compromise, or UAC-0099 attribution.

MITRE ATT&CK

T1036.005

References

1. MATCHBOIL payload and configuration artifact hunt
2. Publication date: 2026-10-08
3. Observed / analyzed activity: samples from 2024-04 through 2026-04; ESET telemetry sightings 2025-07 through 2026-06
4. Primary technical research
5. hxxps://www[.]welivesecurity[.]com/en/eset-research/matchboil-new-tricks-same-old-evil-intentions/
6. ESET Research, "MATCHBOIL: New tricks, same old evil intentions", 2026-10-08.
7. Directly supports the observed installation paths and filenames, delivery chain, persistence mechanisms, sandbox checks, and campaign period.
8. Official telemetry documentation
9. hxxps://learn[.]microsoft[.]com/en-us/defender-xdr/advanced-hunting-devicefileevents-table
10. Microsoft, "DeviceFileEvents table in the advanced hunting schema", documentation updated 2026-06-22.
11. Documents DeviceFileEvents, Timestamp, DeviceId, DeviceName, ActionType, FileName, FolderPath, SHA1, and initiating-process fields.
12. MITRE ATT&CK

Document control

Canonical locked typography and layout. Only the campaign illustration on page 1 is variable.